



ARMY CONTRACTING COMMAND - ABERDEEN PROVING GROUND (ACC-APG)



# The Procurement Pulse

## ACC-APG's Quarterly Industry Newsletter

January 2025 | 2nd Edition

Army Contracting Command Aberdeen Proving Ground (ACC-APG)'s quarterly newsletter, "The Procurement Pulse," is intended to serve as an additional resource to share information about our teams and integrated defense acquisition activities.

Feedback and/or suggestions on types of content for future issues is welcome. [Send us a note!](#)

### ABOUT US

ACC-APG is one of the supporting contracting centers aligned under ACC headquarters, which is a major subordinate command of Army Materiel Command (AMC). ACC-APG provides comprehensive contracting, business advisory support and sustained expertise through eight major competency areas: research and development; command, control, communications, computers, cyber, intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance (C5ISR); test and evaluation; chemical, biological, radiological, and nuclear defense (CBRND), sustainment and Soldier protection; and digital capabilities.

Our executive director and staff components are located at APG, MD; and we have a contracting presence in Adelphi, MD; Ft. Belvoir, VA; Ft. Huachuca, AZ; Frederick, MD; Natick, MA; Research Triangle Park, NC; Tobyhanna Army Depot, PA; Austin, TX; Orlando, FL; and White Sands Missile Range, NM.



# DAU CYBER SOLUTIONS: A WALK-THROUGH OF THE DOD CIO'S CYBERSECURITY MATURITY MODEL CERTIFICATION

**February 25, 2025**  
**1 p.m.— 2 p.m. EST**

Join Defense Acquisition University (DAU) for the first of many official discussions on the DoD CIO's Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) Program. They will take you through the CMMC program requirements at the "101" level where you will gain an understanding of how CMMC will affect DoD acquisitions.

DAU Cyber Solutions is a series of webinars to bring the Acquisition Workforce up-to-speed on all the cybersecurity requirements in federal contracts and how to evaluate those contractual requirements. In the DoD alone, there are some 120K small business contractors and 70% of those contractors have less than 30 employees. This webinar series will educate contracting communities, project managers, and contractors on the resources available to create robust cybersecurity.

Featuring guest speakers, **Ms. Kelley Kiernan, Professor of Cybersecurity for DAU** and **Ms. Dana Mason,**

**Operations Lead, CMMC Program Management Office**, this event will provide insightful discussion and is ideal for any professional with responsibilities for cybersecurity.

For more information and to register, visit:

[DAU Cyber Solutions](#)

## **Kelley Kiernan**

*Professor of Cybersecurity*



Kelley Kiernan is a professor of Cybersecurity and Information Protection at the DoD's Defense Acquisition University. Kelley Kiernan is a cybersecurity and small business ecosystem leader, who applies her experience from Industry, NASA, Navy, Air Force and Space Force to pave the way for robust cybersecurity adoption in the acquisition ecosystem. Kelley is an engineer, scientist and an innovation expert. She is a graduate of the Air Force Academy and served as an Air Force officer where she was a recipient of the Air Medal. Kelley's champion leadership brings robust cybersecurity within the reach of everyone.

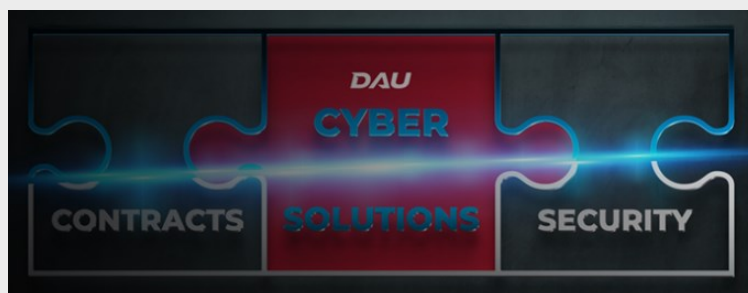
## **Dana Mason**

*Operations Lead, CMMC Program Management Office*



Dana C. Mason serves as Operations Lead in the CMMC Program Management Office within the Office of the DoD CIO. In this position, Mrs. Mason uses her leadership and technical expertise to provide oversight of CMMC Program assessments, ecosystem operations, infrastructure, training, and the CMMC model. She also participates in studies, working groups, and exercises that generate recommendations to improve the cybersecurity posture of the defense industrial base. Prior to joining the DoD CIO, Mrs. Mason was one of the founding members of the Defense Industrial Base Cybersecurity Assessment Center in the Defense Contract Management Agency (DCMA), where she served as a Lead Assessor and Curriculum Development and Training Team Chief. She has also held DCMA positions in the Cybersecurity Directorate as the Audit

Preparedness Program Manager and Cybersecurity Policy Analyst. Mrs. Mason is a U.S. Air Force veteran and holds a Master of Science degree in Information Resource Management and Bachelor of Science degrees in Computer Information System and Management Information Systems. She maintains Certified Governance, Risk and Compliance (CGRC), Certified Information Security Manager (CISM), GIAC Certified Project Manager (GCPM), and Certified Data Privacy Solutions Engineer (CDPSE) certifications and has earned numerous awards for her accomplishments throughout her career.



## APG VENDOR REPORT



ACC-APG is currently rolling out a new Contract Requirements Data List (CDRL) for Cost Plus Fixed Fee (CPFF) Term efforts entitled the APG Vendor Report.

The APG Vendor Report provides information on proposed vs. invoiced direct labor rates for contract management, and for the aggregation of decisional data for senior leadership.

The CDRL will be included in the solicitation of new efforts to ensure proper mapping of labor categories to an established baseline that is used

on other platforms in DoD. Existing contracts will be modified to include the new CDRL. Contractors are encouraged to review the new CDRL carefully, and to address any concerns during the draft RFP phase.

## NEW SERVICE-DISABLED VETERAN-OWNED BUSINESS (SDVOSB) CERTIFICATION RULE

Effective December 16, 2024. FAR Case 2020-009, Certification of Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Businesses. The FINAL RULE was adopted without change to the INTERIM RULE and requires Contract Officers to Verify SDVOSB status for any SDVOSB set-asides. All large primes with SDVOSB subcontracting goals must ensure SDVOSB subcontractors are certified.

- This rule affects procurements that are solicited as a sole source or set-aside using the SDVOSB Program.
- Effective January 1, 2024, an SDVOSB concern must be certified as an SDVOSB concern by SBA, or have both represented that it is an SDVOSB concern in SAM and submitted a complete application for certification to SBA on or before December 31, 2023.
- If a concern is not certified in SAM.gov by the SBA, the KO must check <https://veterans.certify.sba.gov> to ensure a complete application was submitted on/before 31 December 2023, in order to be eligible for these types of awards.
- If the SBA finds a SDVOSB is ineligible, the concern shall update their SAM.gov registration within two (2) business days.
- SBA believes the application process should only take the firm an hour to complete.
- SDVOSB protests will be decided by OHA instead of SBA's Director of Government Contracting.



# BALANCING CONTRACTOR INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS AND GOVERNMENT SUSTAINMENT NEEDS

At Army Contracting Command-Aberdeen Proving Ground (ACC-APG), we strive to balance the intellectual property (IP) rights of our industry partners with the Army's critical need to sustain fielded systems. Recognizing the innovation and investment contractors bring to the table, we work to protect their proprietary interests while ensuring the government can maintain and modernize its products. This balance is vital to mission readiness and operational efficiency.

A key enabler in achieving this balance is the adoption of a Modular Open Systems Approach (MOSA), which promotes interoperable, upgradeable systems. MOSA empowers the government to integrate new technologies and reduce lifecycle costs while avoiding vendor lock-in, all while respecting contractor IP. Complementary strategies like data escrow agreements and Specially Negotiated License Rights (SNLRs) allow the government to access the technical data and data rights needed for sustainment while honoring contractor innovation and proprietary interests.

In addition, public-private partnerships with Tobyhanna Army Depot (TYAD) and the Software Engineering Center (SEC) further strengthen sustainment efforts by leveraging depot-level expertise and fostering collaboration with industry. Together, these approaches ensure the Army maintains mission-critical capabilities across the lifecycle of its systems while safeguarding contractor innovation. At ACC-APG, this alignment reflects our commitment to delivering sustainable, innovative solutions for the warfighter.



## STAY CONNECTED!

### OFFICE OF SMALL BUSINESS PROGRAMS

[APG](#)  
[DEVCOM](#)

### ACC-APG POINTS OF CONTACT

[APG Executive Director Meeting Requests](#)  
[Digital Capabilities Contracting Center of Excellence \(DC3oE\)](#)  
[Source Selection Support Center of Excellence \(S3CoE\)](#)  
[Software License Innovation Contracting Office](#)



## ON THE HORIZON

### UPCOMING EVENTS

February 12, 2025: [ACC-APG S3CoE DoD U.S. Cybersecurity Strategies for DoD Acquisitions Symposium](#)

February 19, 2025: PEO IEWS/PM C&S Task Order Effort  
(note: invites will be sent directly to RS3 vendors)

June 17, 2025: [Radiation Detection Industry Day](#)

### MORE TO COME...

will be announced on [SAM.gov](#)

2QFY25: Installation & Technology Software License Innovative Contracting Office Symposium

2QFY25: Army Communications-Electronics Command (CECOM) Security Assistance Management Directorate (SAMD) Foreign Military Sales Informational Session

2QFY25: Information Management Communication Services (IMCS) IDIQ IPR

3QFY25: Army Evaluation Center Omnibus Industry Day

3QFY25: Team Aberdeen Proving Ground (APG) Advance Planning Briefing to Industry (APBI)

[Email the S3CoE](#) for information regarding upcoming events and/or to be added to our contact list.

**THIS WE'LL DEFEND. BE ALL YOU CAN BE. WIN EVERY DAY.**